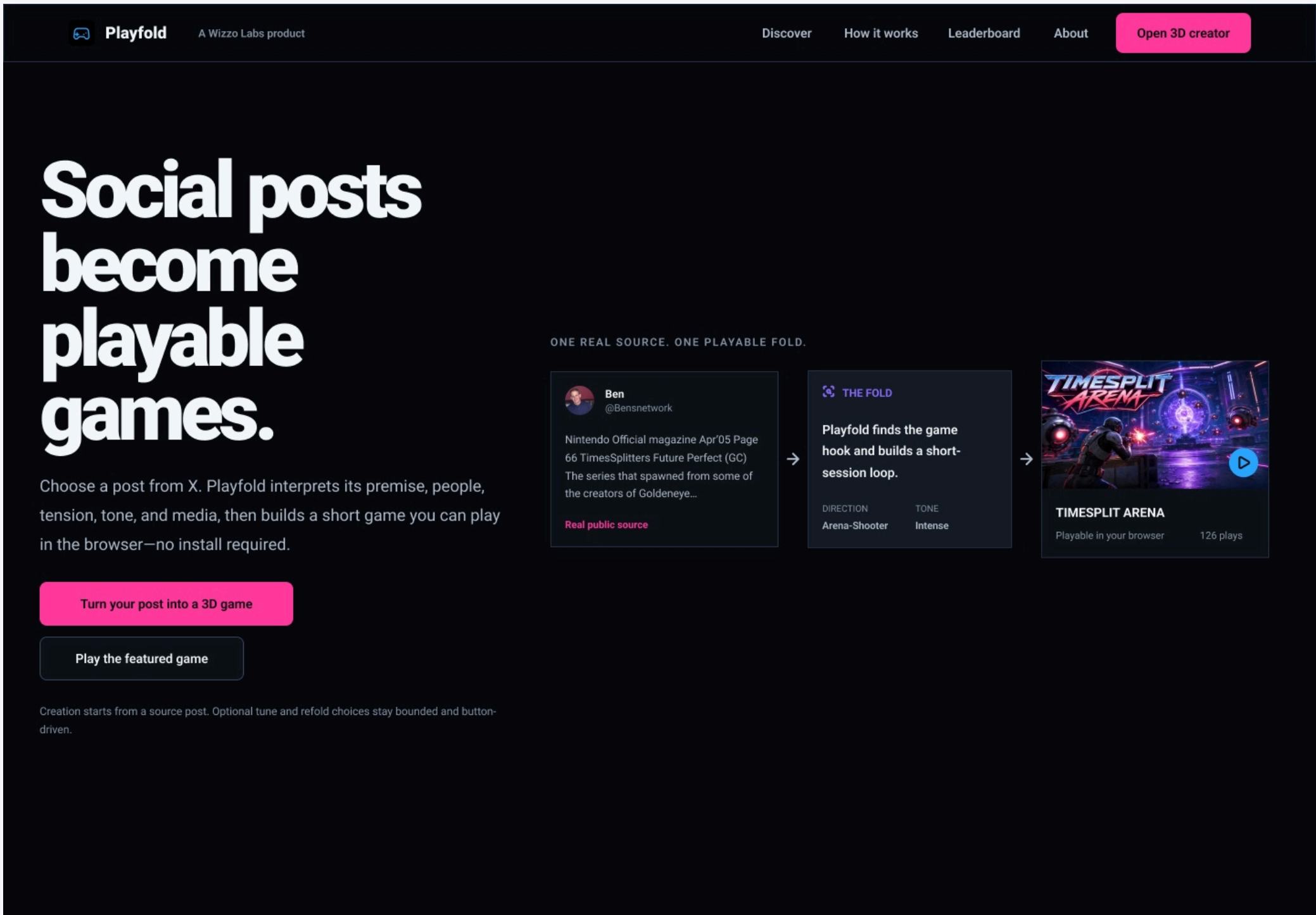


From source to discovery and play

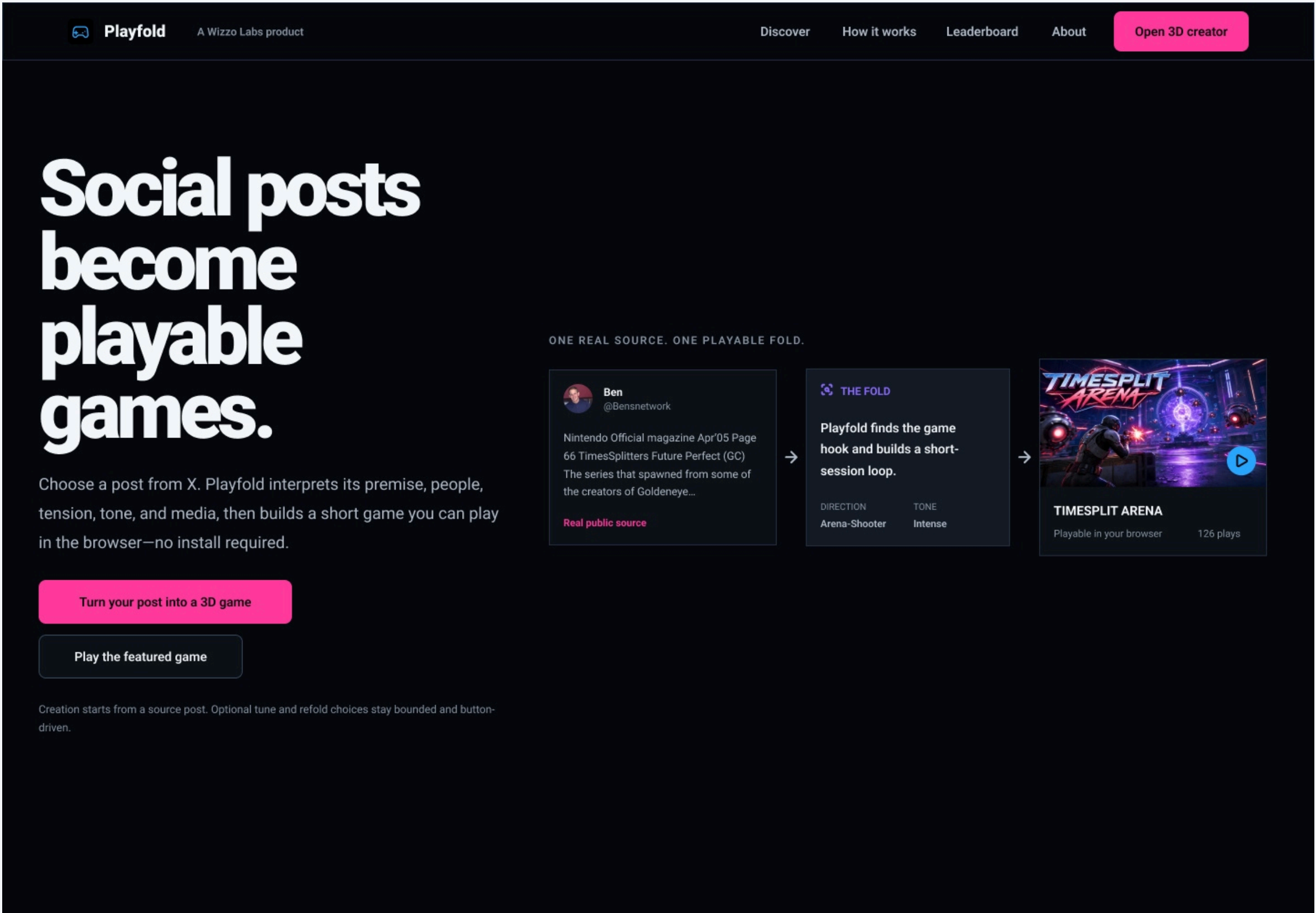
I’m Mike Chaves, founder of Wizzo Labs. I own Playfold’s product direction, interaction design, visual system and engineering. This case study connects the homepage, discovery, public play, rankings and account navigation, then examines a focused private-result refinement. Public UI represents the existing product; Signal Range is a simulated scenario, and its result proposal remains pending my design review.



The existing product first; a bounded source-to-private-result exploration follows.

An invitation to explore and create

I use the homepage to connect Playfold’s proposition with an immediate example. Source-to-game explanation, featured play and distinct Create and Discover actions give the introduction a clear next step.



Current homepage variant. The full native page includes source-to-game explanation, public examples, product tour, product differences, support and footer.

Show how a source becomes play

Below the opening invitation, I explain the source-to-game relationship and show public examples before the product tour. The lower page continues through the product’s differences, support and footer, keeping the introduction connected to concrete destinations.

SOURCE TO GAME

The post stays part of the play.

Playfold starts with context already moving through X, selects a playable hook automatically, and keeps the source connected through public attribution and supported follow-on actions.



01



Choose a source post

Open your X timeline and select Turn into game on the post you want to play.

02



Find the game hook

Playfold interprets the premise, people, tension, tone, and available media, then chooses a playable direction.

03



Build and validate

Generation assembles the objective, controls, feedback, art, and complete short-session loop.

04



Play in the browser

Launch the game on desktop or mobile with no download or engine install.

05

Keep the source connected

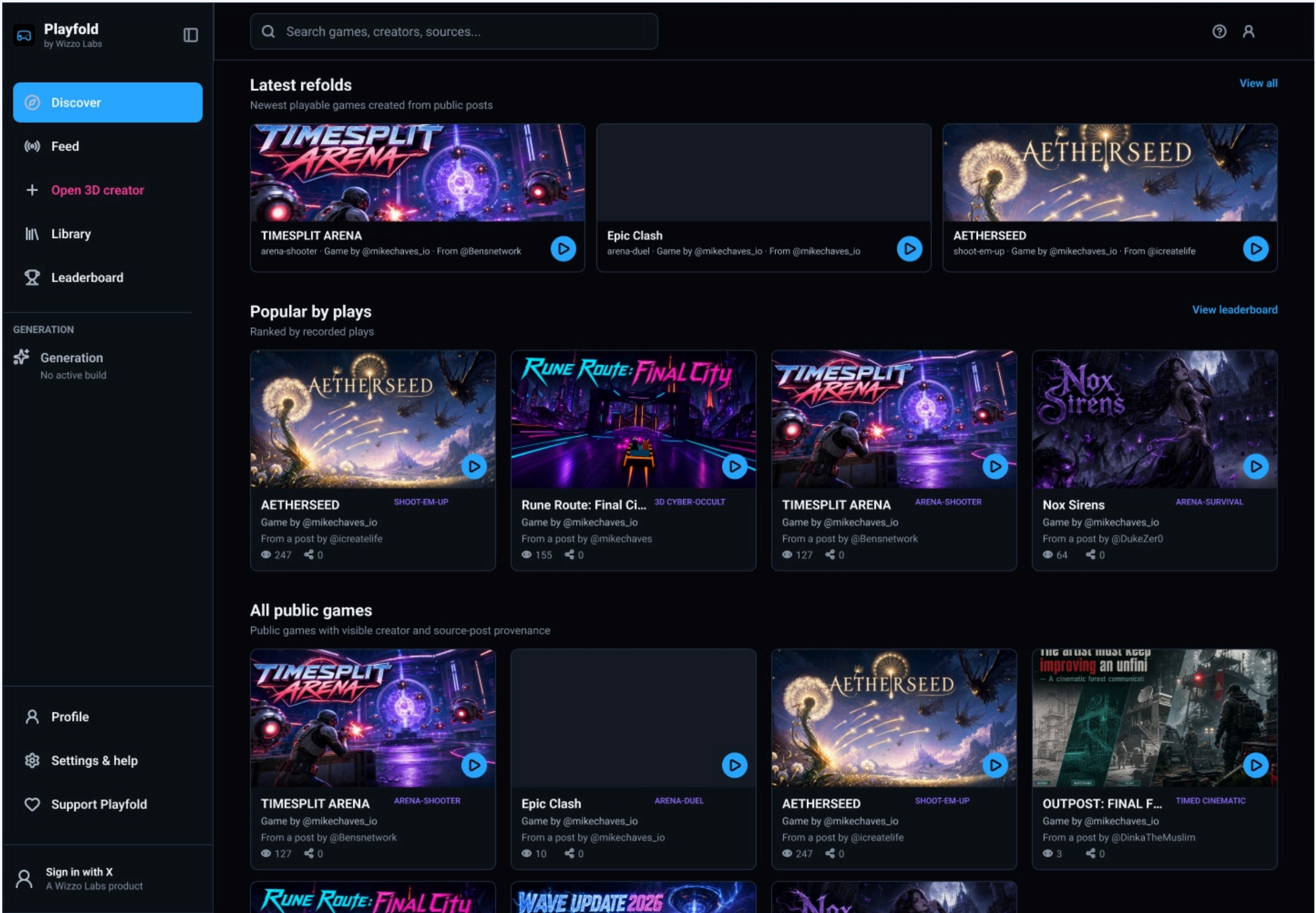
Save, share, challenge, tune, or refold when the game supports those actions.

[See the complete process](#)

The homepage’s source-to-game explanation. The native desktop and mobile pages retain the complete lower-page structure.

Make a catalog feel worth exploring

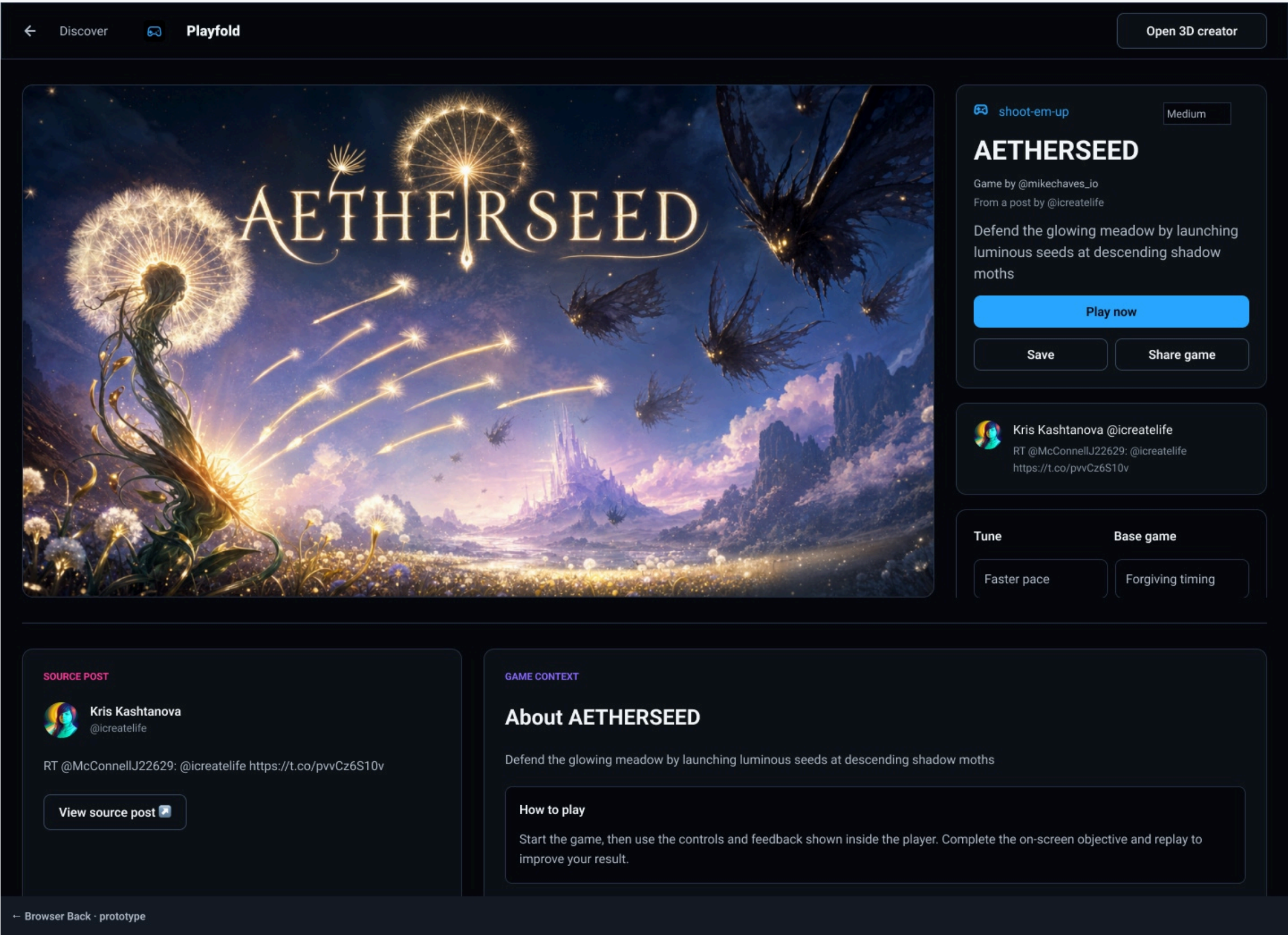
I carry the game’s identity through wide cards for the latest refolds, a popular shelf and a denser browse grid. Artwork invites exploration; titles and creator/source labels keep the selection understandable.



Discover uses /games. AETHERSEED is the connected walkthrough example; other cards preserve the observed catalog’s identities and artwork.

Keep context beside the game

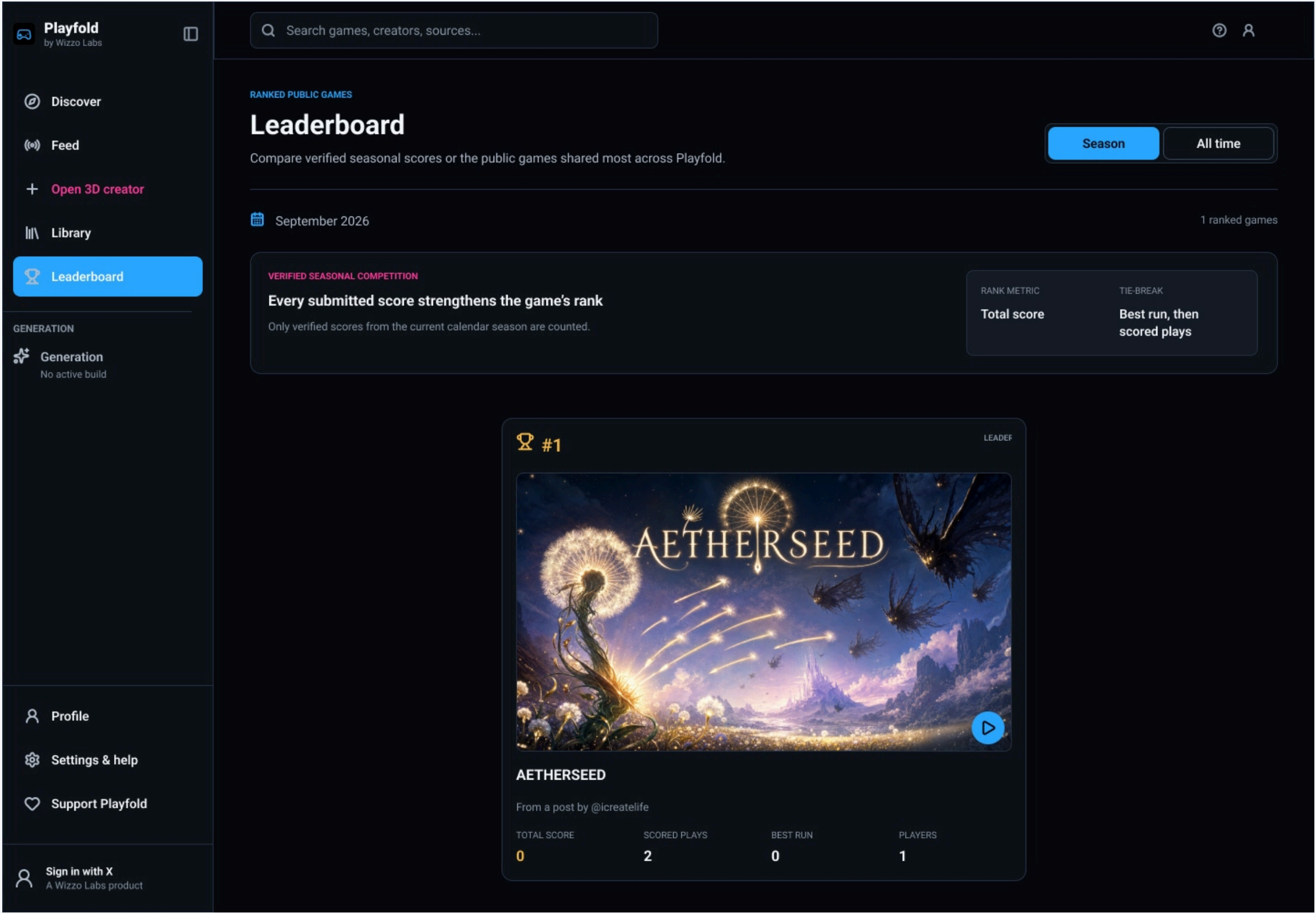
I separate the focused game area from the app rail while keeping the title, objective, creator and source close to Play. Instructions lead into the same AETHERSEED game, with source context farther down the page.



Existing public-game composition. Figma changes platform states; the game scene is a capture and does not execute the runtime.

Explain what a ranking measures

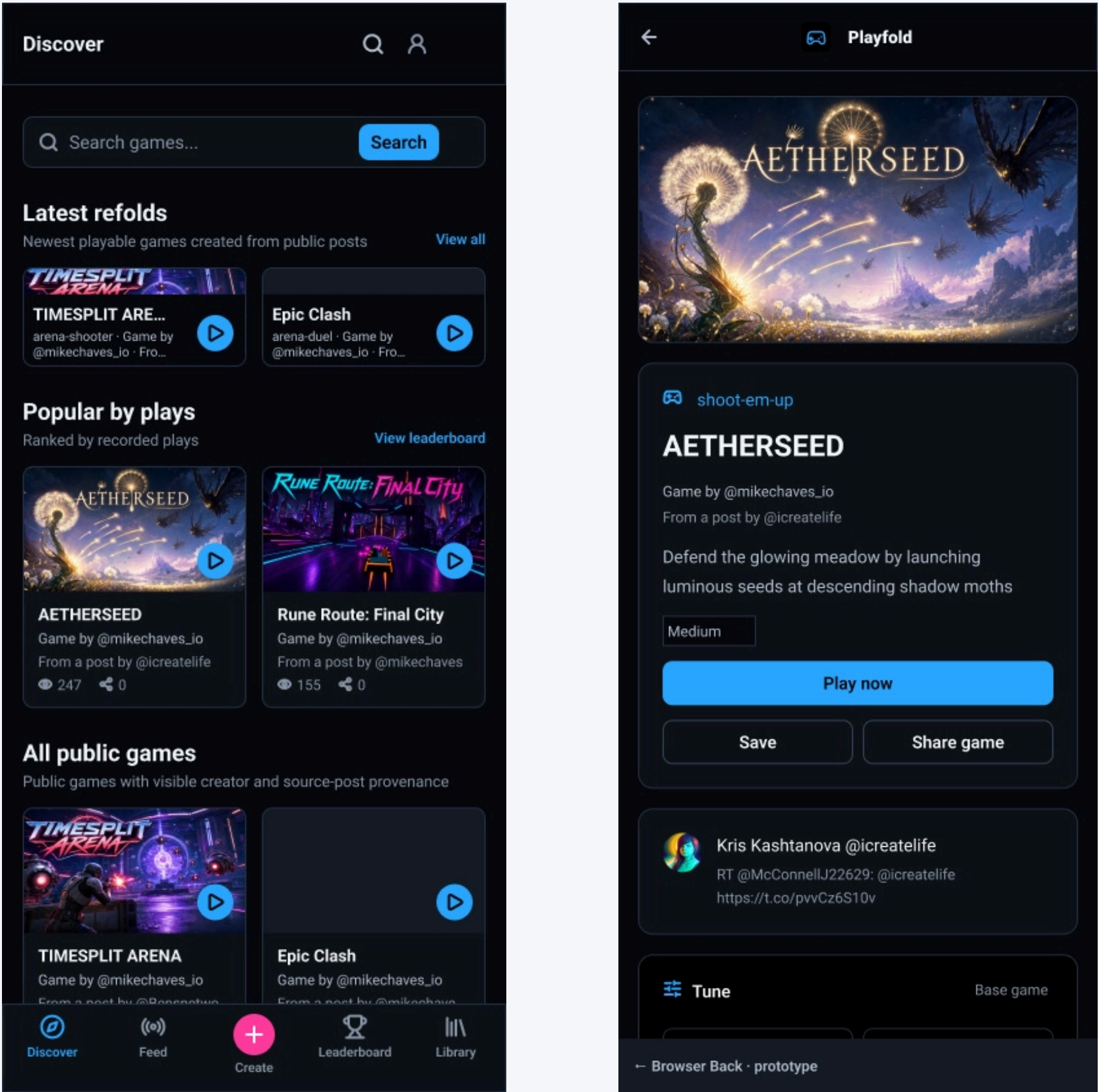
I make the ranking model explicit. Season ranks games by total verified score, then best run and scored plays. All time ranks public games by shares, with plays as the tie-break. The podium introduces the leaders before compact rows continue the list.



Illustrative ranking dataset. The current product resets All time to Season after leaving and returning; the prototype preserves that observed limitation.

Adapt navigation to the task

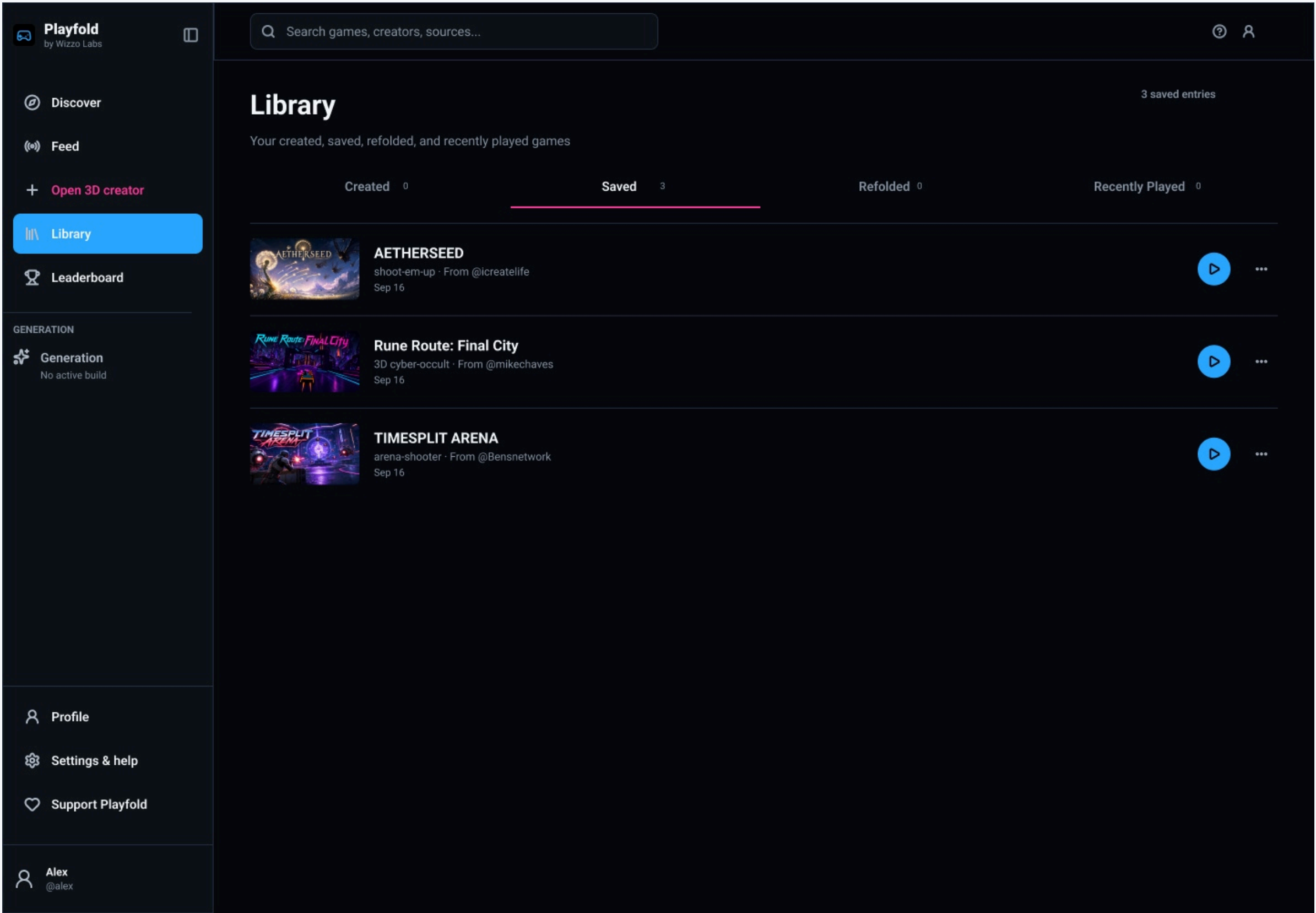
I keep app destinations in a desktop rail and mobile bottom navigation. Focused play removes those distractions, while its own return control and scrollable source content keep the page connected.



Mobile Discover and AETHERSEED. The dedicated browser-return bar models browser Back; the product’s Back to Discover control clears the search query.

Give saved work a clear home

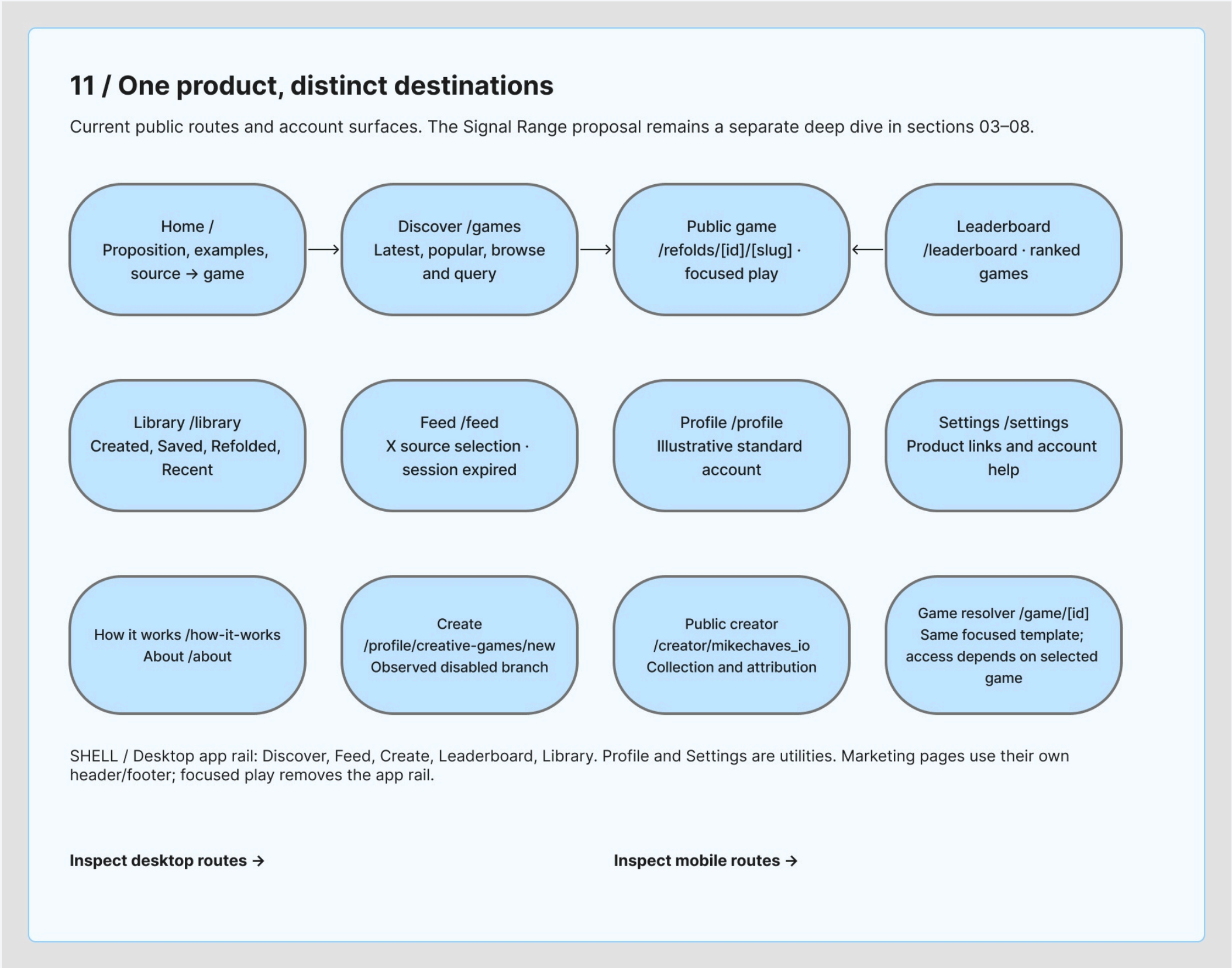
I keep Created, Saved, Refolded and Recent visible as different views. A public bookmark opens the public game; it does not become a creator-private result or imply a new release.



Illustrative standard-account Library. Source state initializes Created on remount; authenticated browser-return behavior remains unverified.

Connect the principal destinations

I connect the marketing pages, public catalog and focused game with Library, Feed, Profile and Settings. These destinations have distinct jobs while sharing recognizable navigation and visual rules.



Route-level hierarchy from the connected FigJam board. Feed, Profile and gated account examples use permitted local states where live access is unavailable.

Keep the source relationship legible

Playfold starts from source material instead of a blank game prompt. The current private creator accepts the signed-in person’s own X post with text and a static image. Source author and game creator remain separate concepts, even when one person fills both roles. Keeping those labels distinct helps the player understand origin without implying that attribution grants redistribution rights.

Source · Alex Rivera

Own X post · demo source
Text + Image 1

Attribution identifies origin; it does not grant redistribution rights.

Game · Alex Rivera

Signal Range
Clear the signal targets

A private saved result preserves a separate game identity.

source-backed baseline

One scenario across every decision

Alex Rivera wants to create, inspect and reopen Signal Range privately. The selected source says: “Calibrate a signal array by clearing unstable beacons before the interference swallows the range.” Image 1 is the local signal-grid fixture. Sam Chen later opens a simulated published version of the same game. Its objective is Clear the signal targets: three targets, with failure after three hits. These values describe the task, not product usage.

Alex · creator

Create, inspect and reopen Signal Range privately.

Selected source: Image 1 in the owned post.

Signal Range

Clear the signal targets.

3 targets · maximum 3 hits
Illustrative game rules.

Sam · player

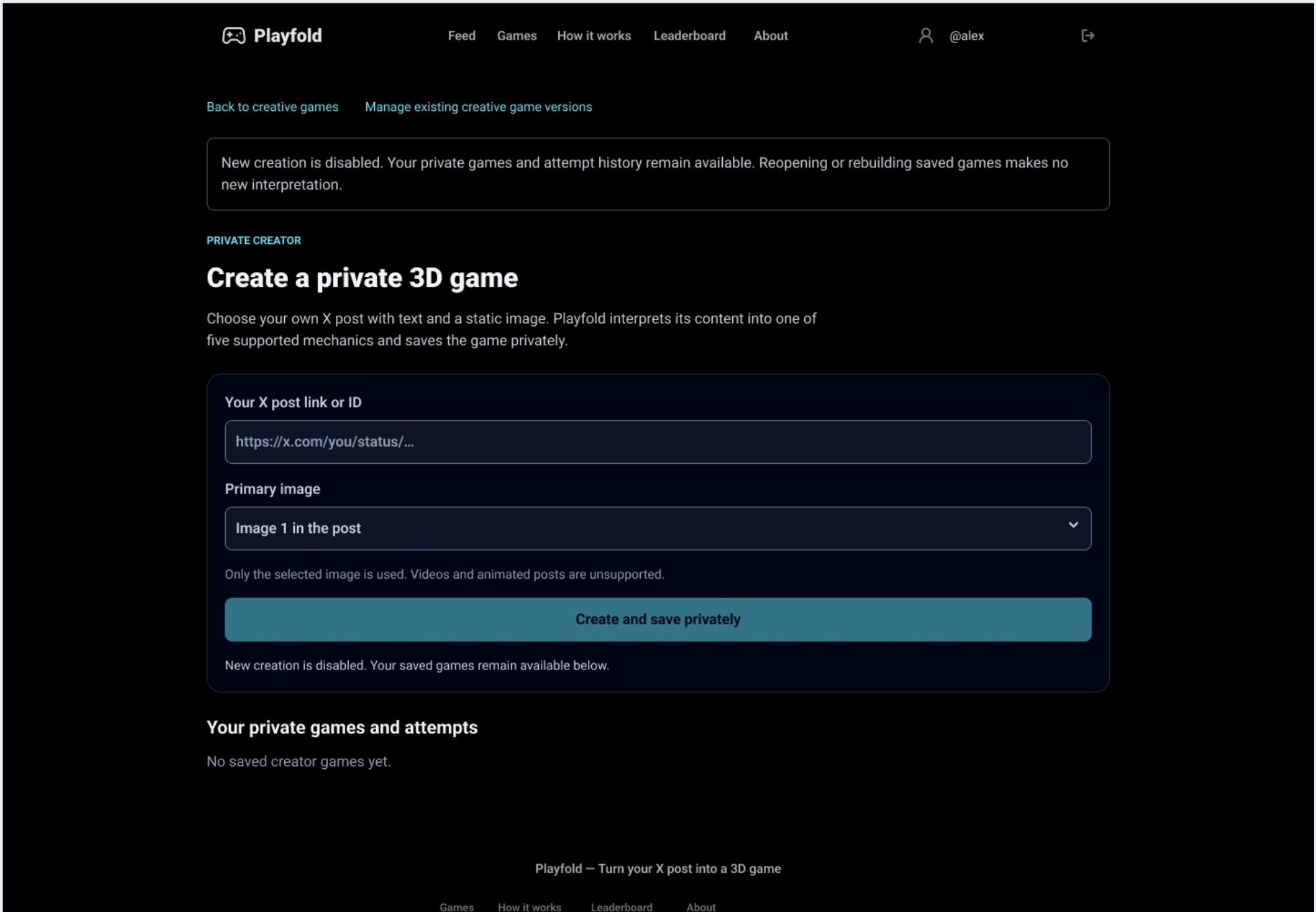
Open the same game in a simulated published context.

Read the controls, play, restart and return.

illustrative fixture

Bound the input before creation

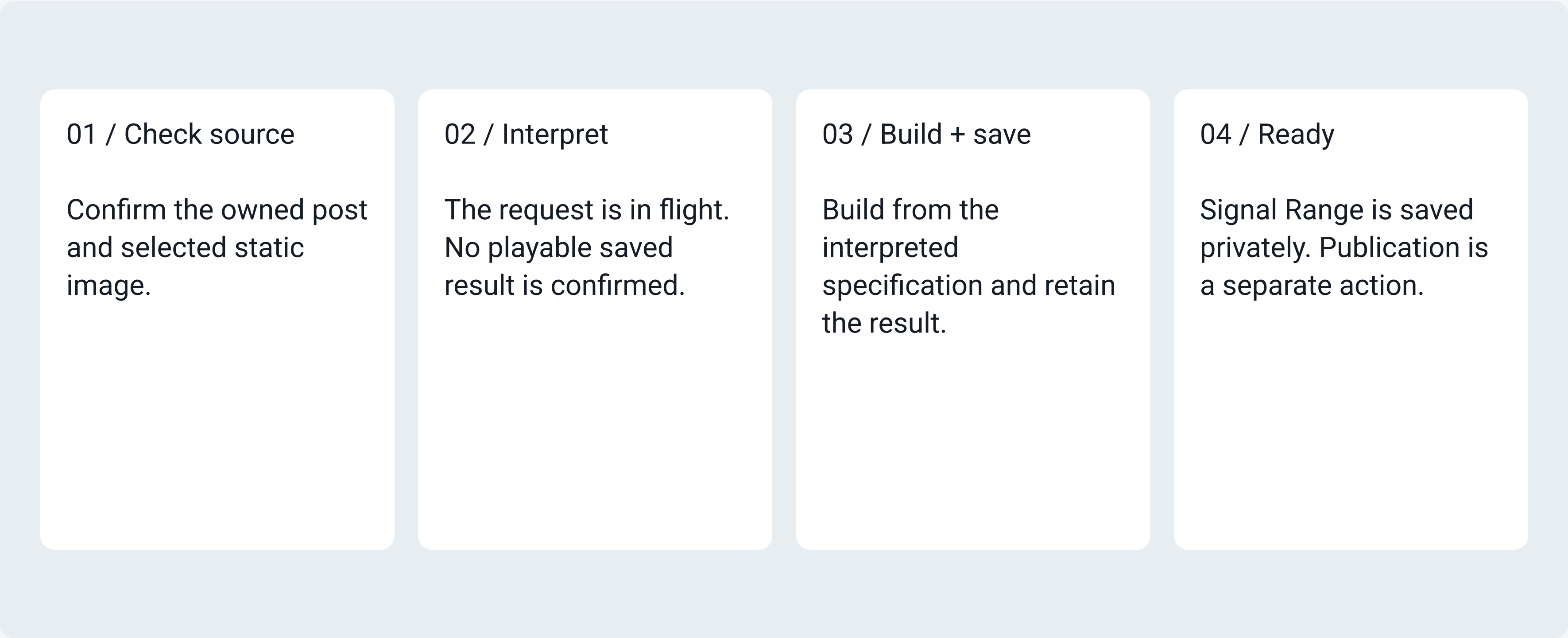
The current form asks for Your X post link or ID and Primary image. The selector offers Image 1 through Image 4 in the post; only the chosen image is used. Videos and animated posts are unsupported in this creator flow. The baseline keeps Create and save privately disabled while allowing access to saved work. The separate simulated entry explores the workflow without making generation available.



source-backed disabled baseline

Name the outcome accurately

Checking source, Interpreting and Building and saving communicate different stages. A generated candidate is not yet a playable saved result. Ready — saved privately confirms that the retained specification and image are available to the owner. The original action already requested private saving, so the result does not introduce a second Save step. Publication remains outside this sequence.



simulated implemented flow

Cancellation cannot undo an outcome

Cancel remaining creation requests a stop to remaining work. An interpretation already in flight may still finish, so the intermediate state says cancellation requested and waits for the outcome. The cancel action becomes unavailable while that request is pending. A late private result must retain its identity and explain what happened; a prototype must not jump straight to a promise that nothing was created.

Remaining work

Cancel remaining creation requests a stop.

It cannot undo an interpretation already in flight.

Request pending

Repeated cancellation is unavailable.

Wait for the final outcome of this same attempt.

Resolve honestly

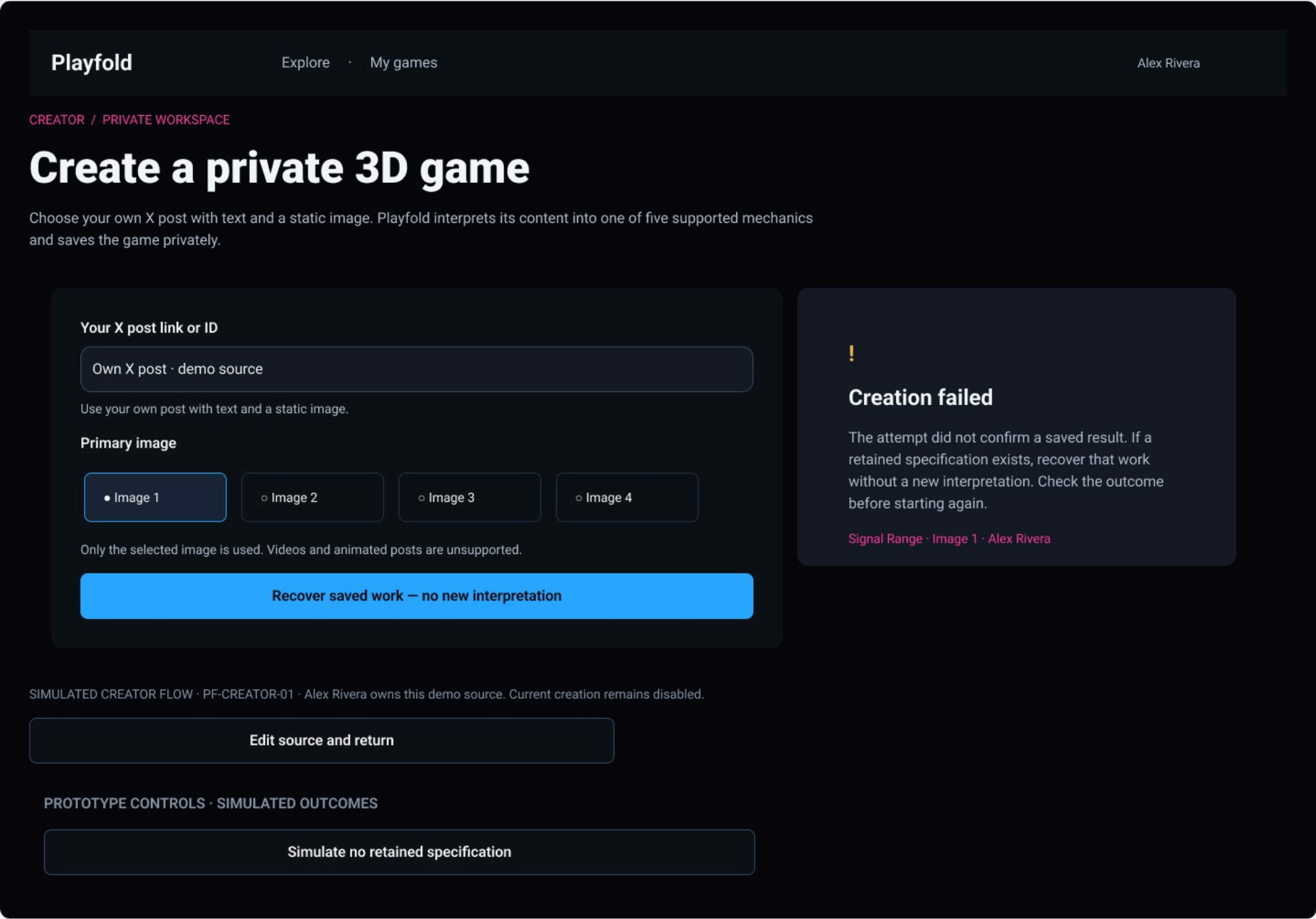
Late saved result → explain private save.

Failure → review or recover retained work.

simulated implemented flow

Recovery should preserve the attempt

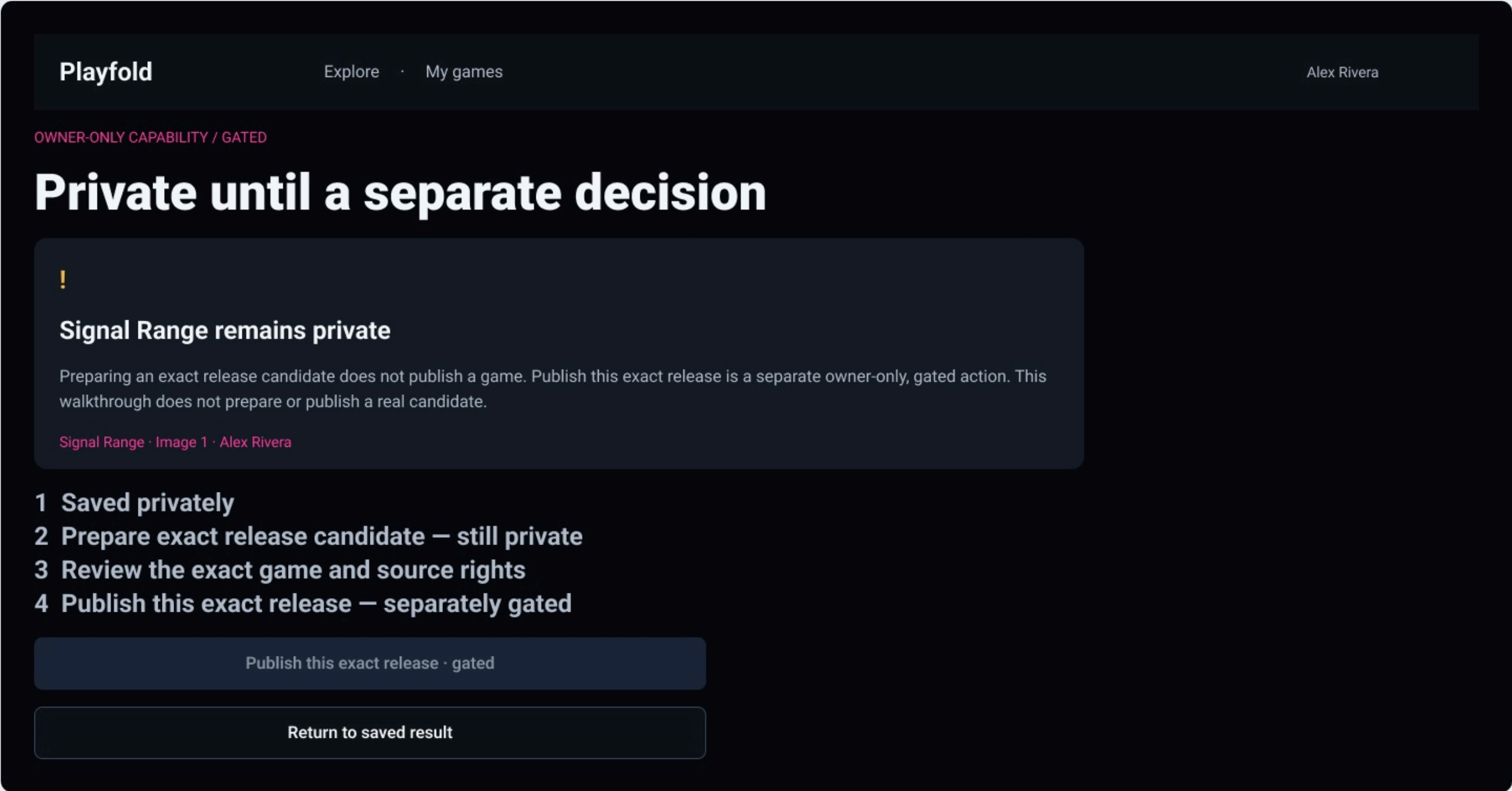
Creation failed and Outcome needs review need different explanations from ordinary waiting. Recover saved work — no new interpretation uses any valid saved specification; it may fail when none exists. The inspected app also offers Rebuild from saved spec for retained work. The prototype separates its recovery path from the preferred saved receipt. Reopening Signal Range from private history returns to the same result and selected source; it does not request a new interpretation.



source-backed recovery semantics

Private is a meaningful boundary

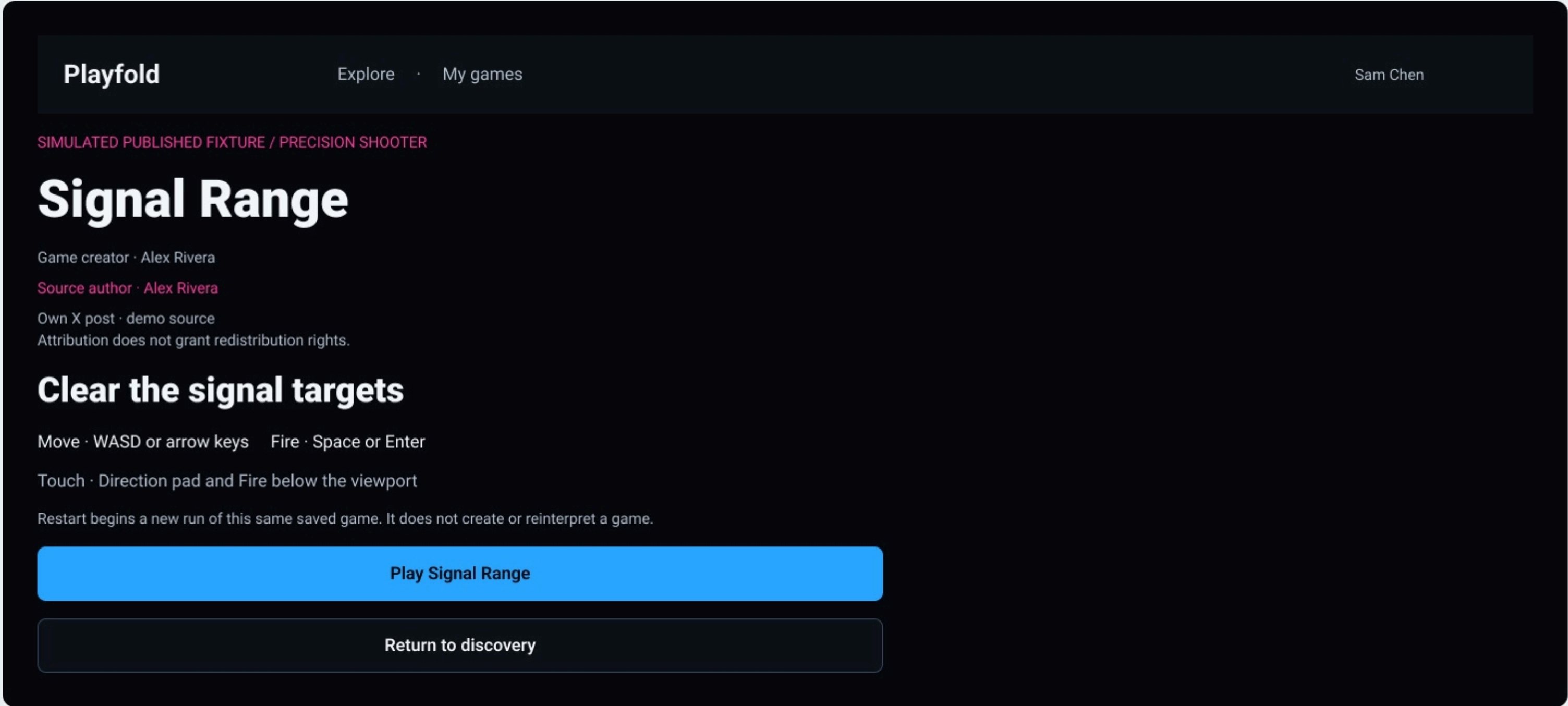
Private saving gives the owner a durable result. Preparing a public release still keeps that result private. Owner-only release review separately considers the game, key art and material proposed for redistribution. Publish this exact release is unavailable until the required reviews and authority are present. The player prototype’s published fixture is a simulation, not a shortcut around this boundary.



baseline boundary; simulated publication context

Let the player understand the invitation

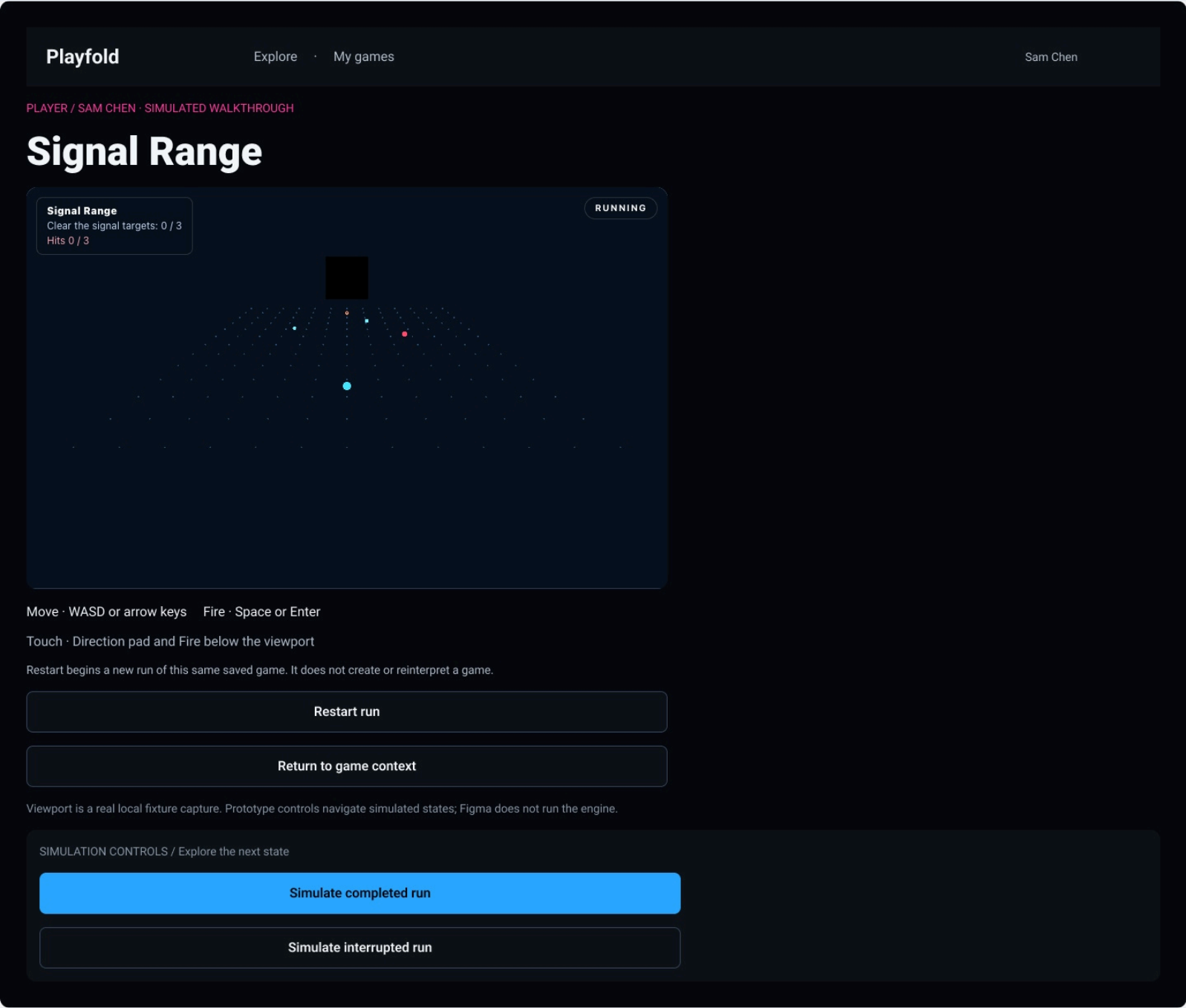
Sam opens Signal Range from a simulated discovery card. The card identifies the game and its creator; the context view also identifies Alex as the source author. Before play, Sam can understand the objective and controls without searching through creation details. Returning from the player leads back to the same discovery context. The fixture has no fabricated play counts, scores or social proof.



simulated published fixture

Separate platform controls from game rules

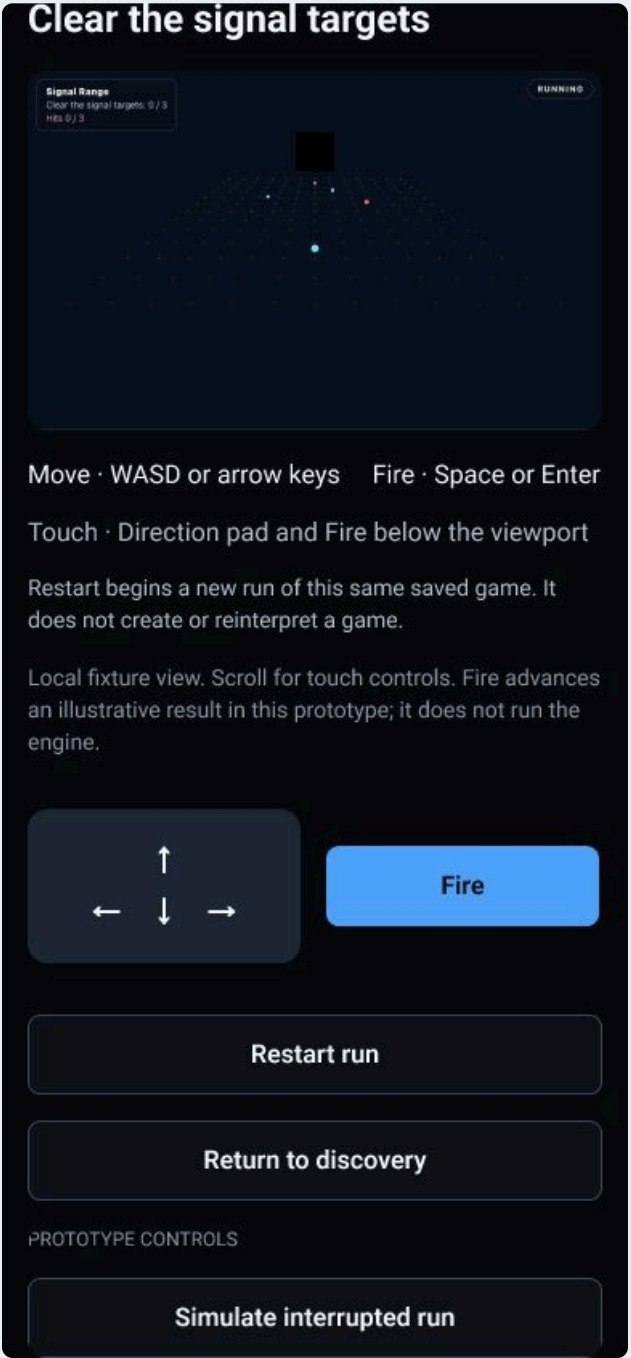
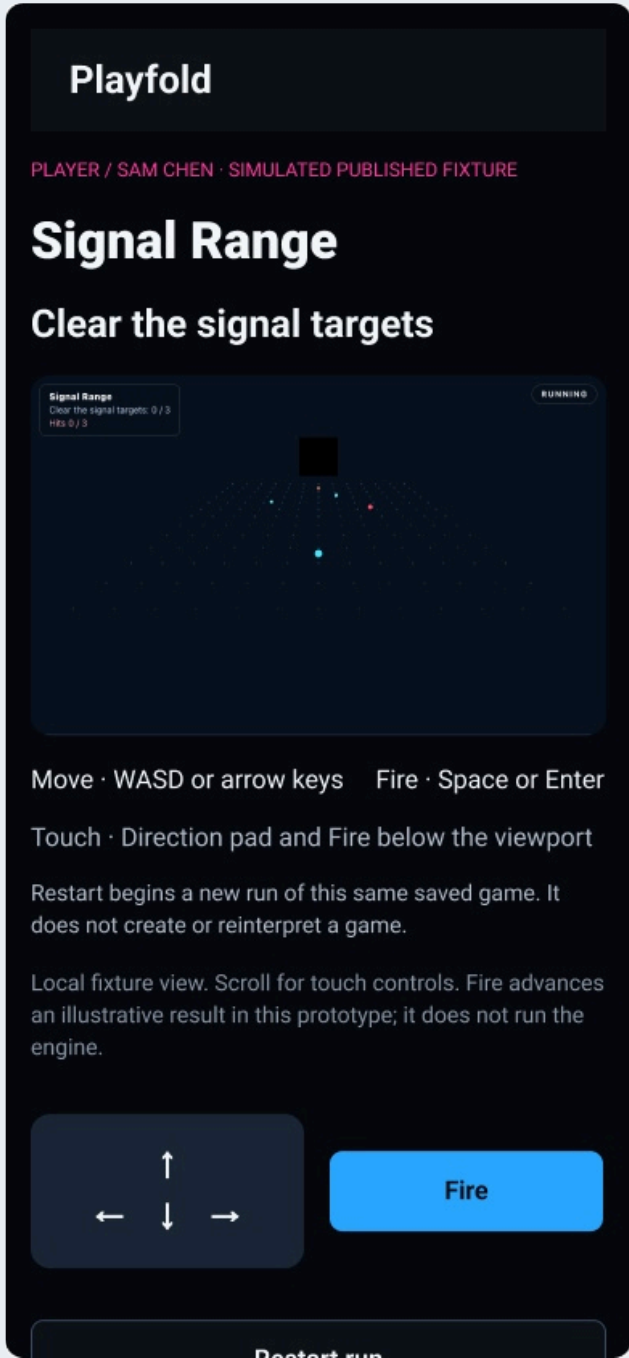
Signal Range’s objective is Clear the signal targets. The inspected runtime supports WASD or arrows, Space or Enter, touch movement, Fire and Restart. Its three-target objective and Hits indicator belong to the game’s HUD. The application also provides fullscreen controls. The selected prototype focuses on source context, instructions, simulated play and outcomes; it does not demonstrate fullscreen behavior or execute the WebGL engine.



source-backed controls; simulated play

A mobile flow must reach its actions

On a narrow screen, the source summary, game viewport and controls need a usable order. I show the actual scrolled Signal Range prototype so movement, Fire and Restart are reachable below the viewport. This fixture isolates control access; the earlier public-product pages show the full app shell and AETHERSEED focused page.



Top → scrolled

The second capture comes from a real scroll in presentation mode.

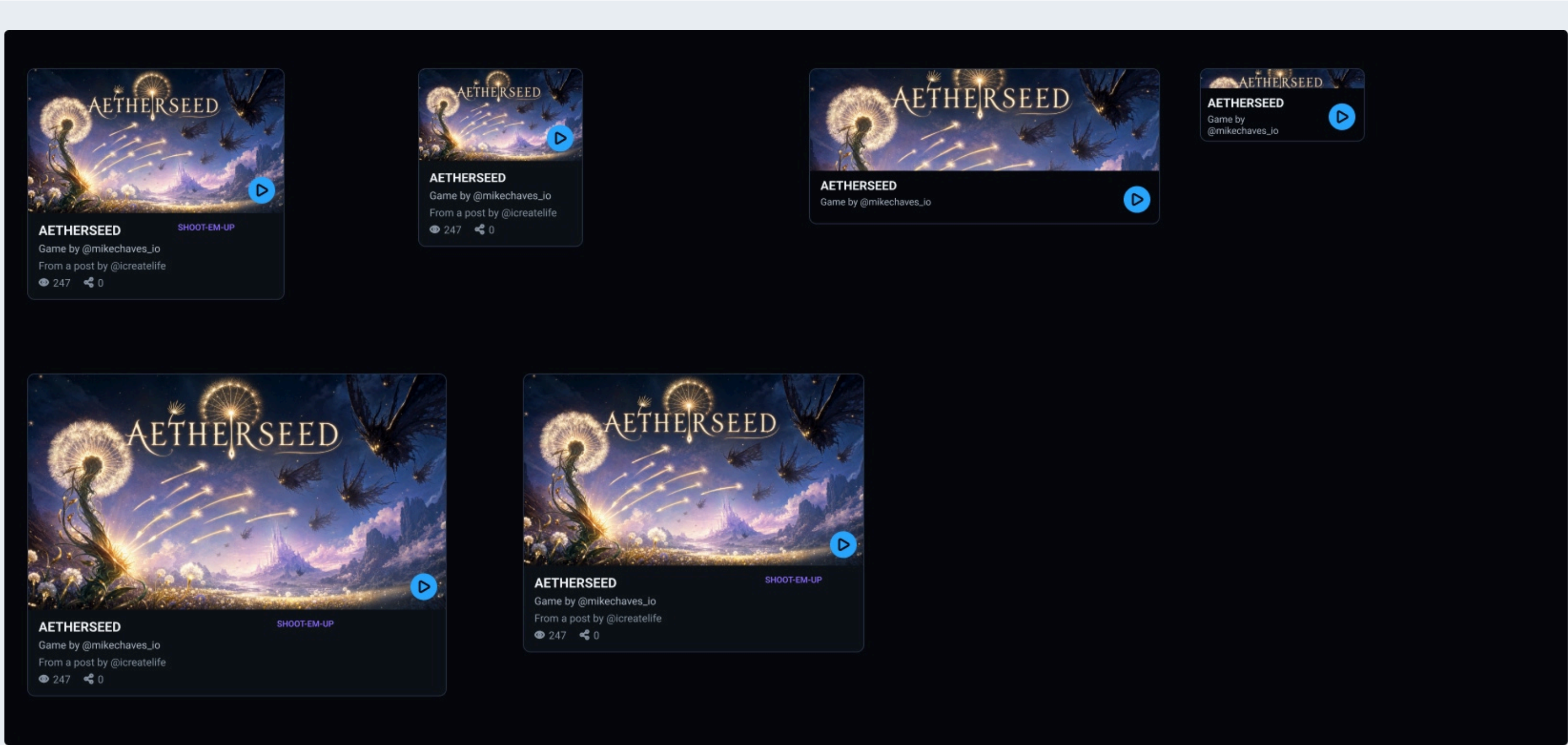
Movement, Fire, Restart and Return are reachable.

Fire navigates to an illustrative result; it does not run the engine.

responsive design specification

Reuse meaning as well as appearance

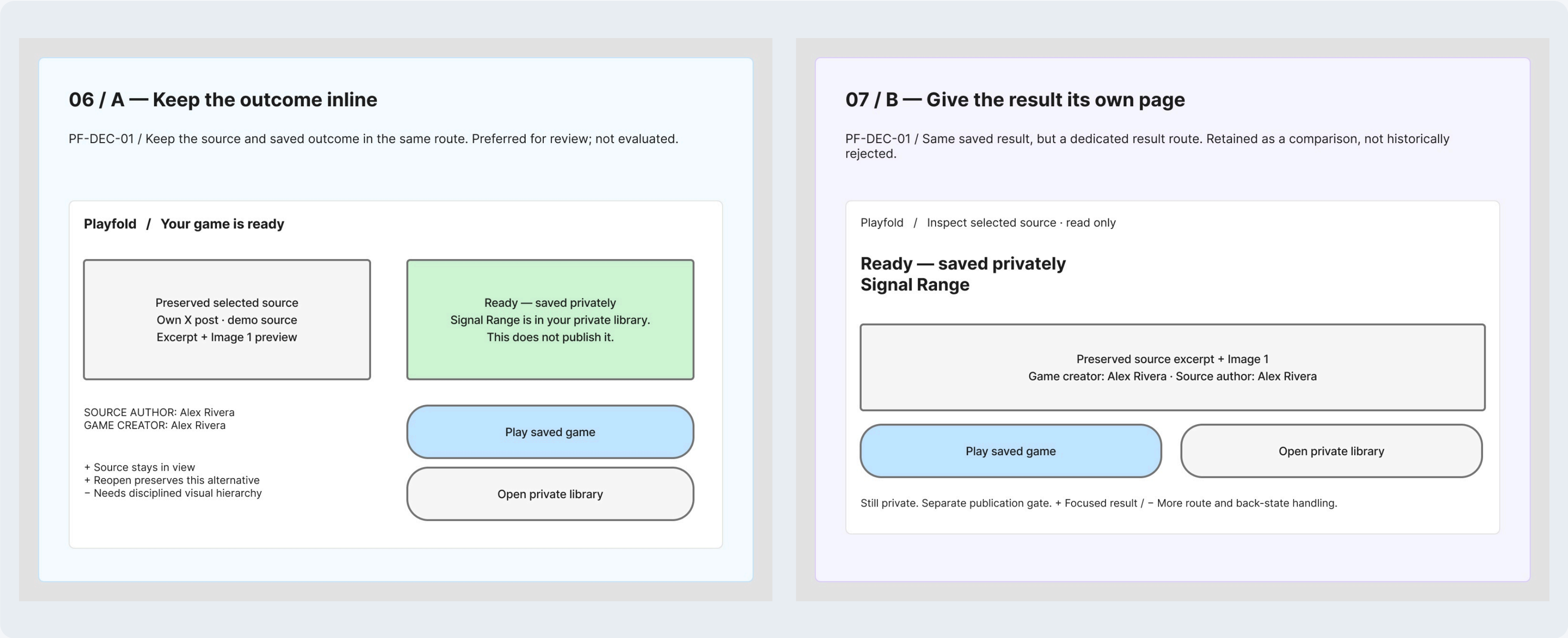
Playfold’s adaptive palette separates play actions, source context and Refold with blue, pink and violet roles. Dark surface levels establish hierarchy without competing with gameplay. Native action, attribution, game-card and outcome components carry consistent labels and states. The design system maps back to the current CSS roles while documenting the existing creator surface’s slate/cyan variation. Roboto is the Figma working face; production keeps its system-font stack.



source mapping and design specification

Two approaches to the same result

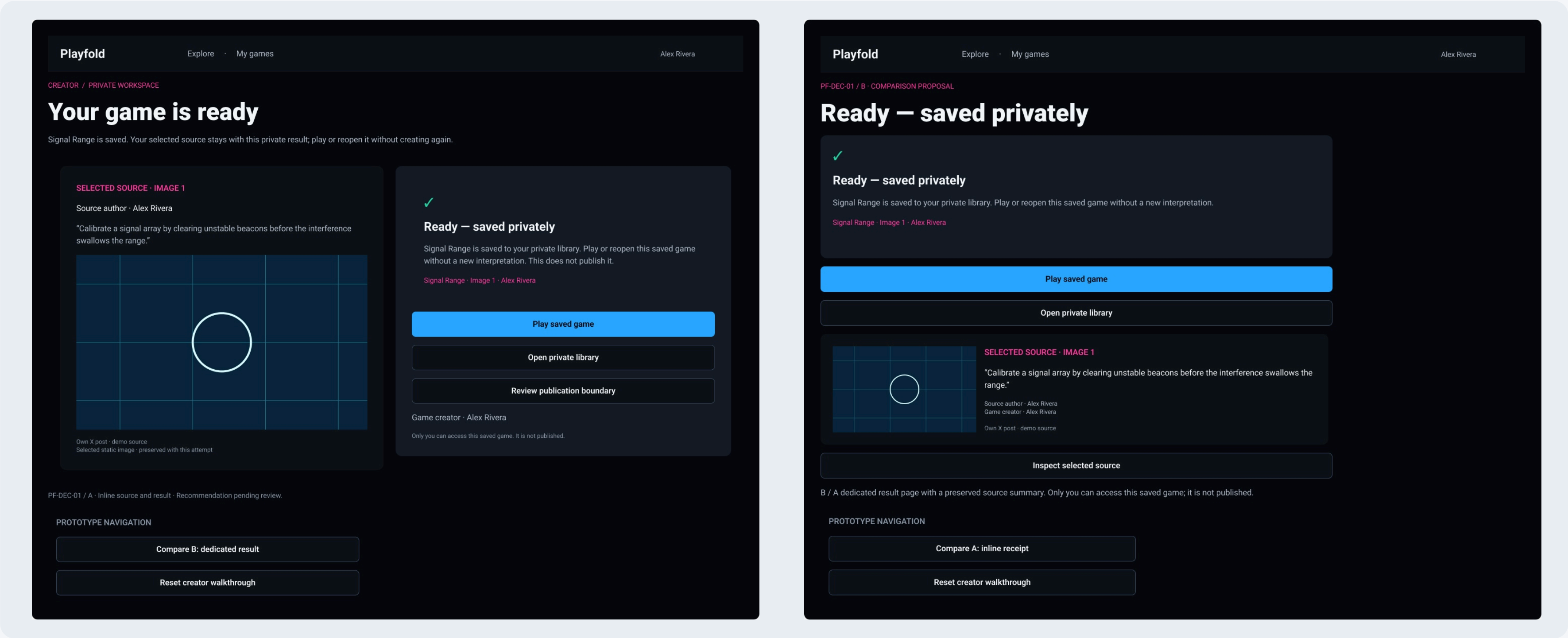
The exploration asks whether the end of an attempt clearly explains who can access the result and how to recover it. Alternative A places an outcome receipt beside the selected attempt. Alternative B gives the result a dedicated page with more space for source context and play. Both use the same private Signal Range result, identical action meanings and the same failure scenarios.



unevaluated alternatives

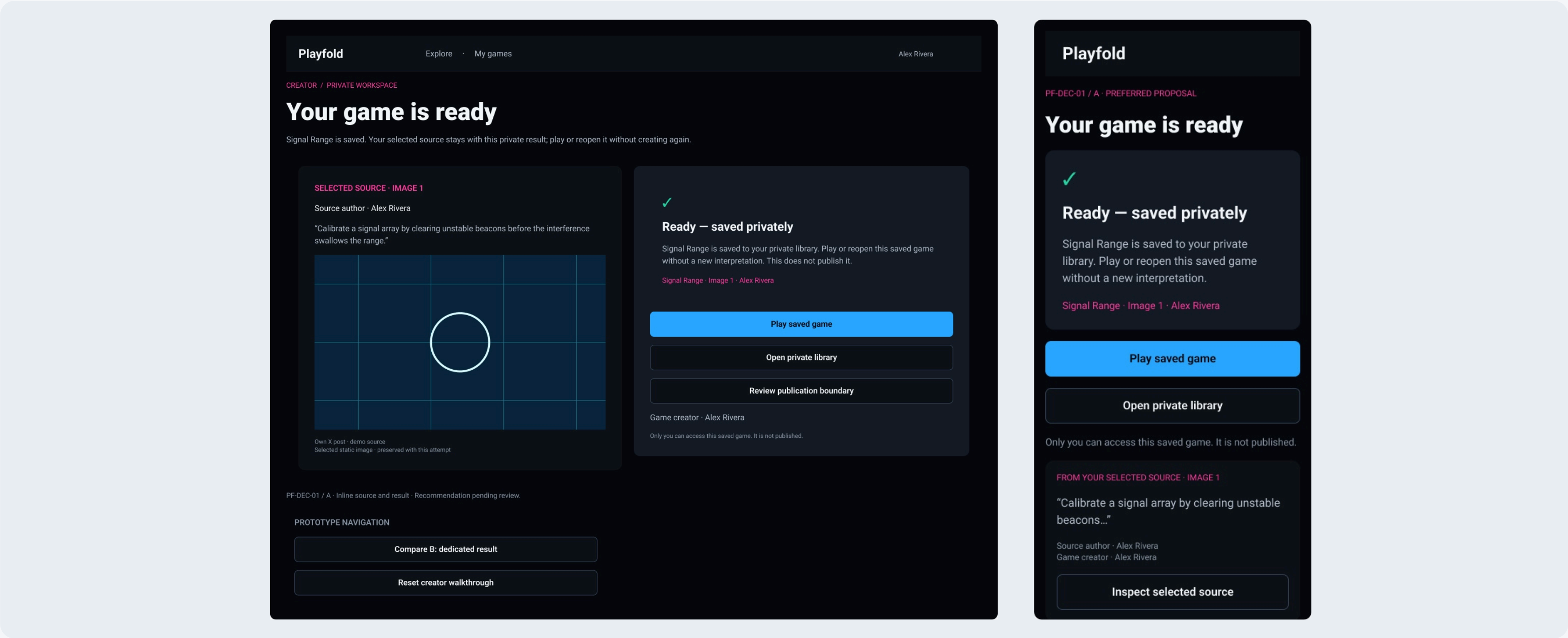
Compare consequences, not preference alone

An inline receipt preserves route and selection context and keeps recovery close to the attempt. A dedicated page offers stronger separation and more space, but introduces navigation and state handoff. The comparison considers comprehension, control, hierarchy, recovery, accessibility, narrow-screen reach and implementation implications. These are design judgments to test, not participant findings or a validated winner.



Prefer a receipt that stays with the work

I recommend Alternative A for review. The inline receipt groups Signal Range, Private status and Only you can open this saved game with Play saved game and Open private library. A preserved source excerpt and Image 1 keep the result tied to the attempt. Read-only source inspection returns to that saved result. Recovery remains a separate path, and the refinement changes neither creation authority nor public visibility.



preferred proposal design review pending

Evaluate comprehension and control

I plan task-based sessions around finding a public game, understanding its controls, interpreting game rankings and returning to discovery. Creator tasks test private visibility, reopening and retained-work recovery. I use AI assistance for source review, alternatives, critique and consistency checks. Participant findings, design acceptance and implementation approval remain open; prototype checks do not establish business impact.

Creator tasks

- Explain who can open the result.
- Reopen without creating again.
- Explain what recovery reuses.

Player tasks

- Find Fire after scrolling.
- Interpret a completed or interrupted run.
- Restart and return.

Record evidence

- Action + hesitation + interpretation + severity.
- Leave findings empty until real sessions occur.

planned evaluation